

5: Part 1 - Data Visualization Basics

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Objectives

1. Perform simple data visualizations in the R package `ggplot`
2. Develop skills to adjust aesthetics and layers in graphs
3. Apply a decision tree framework for appropriate graphing methods

Opening discussion

Effective data visualization depends on purposeful choices about graph types. The ideal graph type depends on the type of data and the message the visualizer desires to communicate. The best visualizations are clear and simple. A good resource for data visualization is Data to Viz, which includes both a decision tree for visualization types and explanation pages for each type of data, including links to R resources to create them. Take a few minutes to explore this website.

Set Up

```
getwd()
```

```
## [1] "/home/guest/ciraortizenviron872"
```

```
library(tidyverse);library(lubridate);library(here)
install.packages("ggribes")
library(ggribes)
```

```
here()
```

```
## [1] "/home/guest/ciraortizenviron872"
```

```
#loading datasets
```

```
PeterPaul.chem.nutrients <-
```

```
  read.csv(here("./Data/Processed/Processed_KEY/NTL-LTER_Lake_Chemistry_Nutrients_PeterPaul_Processed.csv"),
           stringsAsFactors = TRUE)
```

```
PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered <-
```

```
  read.csv(here("./Data/Processed/Processed_KEY/NTL-LTER_Lake_Nutrients_PeterPaulGathered_Processed.csv"),
           stringsAsFactors = TRUE)
```

```

EPAair <- read.csv(here("Data/Processed/Processed_KEY/EPAair_03_PM25_NC1819_Processed.csv"),
                  stringsAsFactors = TRUE)

EPAair$Date <- ymd(EPAair$Date)
PeterPaul.chem.nutrients$sampldate <- ymd(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients$sampldate)
PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered$sampldate <- ymd(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered$sampldate)

```

ggplot

ggplot, called from the package **ggplot2**, is a graphing and image generation tool in R. This package is part of tidyverse. While base R has graphing capabilities, ggplot has the capacity for a wider range and more sophisticated options for graphing. ggplot has only a few rules:

- The first line of ggplot code always starts with **ggplot()**
- A data frame must be specified within the **ggplot()** function. Additional datasets can be specified in subsequent layers.
- Aesthetics must be specified, most commonly x and y variables but including others. Aesthetics can be specified in the **ggplot()** function or in subsequent layers.
- Additional layers must be specified to fill the plot.

Geoms - comes in second layer

Here are some commonly used layers for plotting in ggplot:

- **geom_bar**
- **geom_histogram**
- **geom_freqpoly**
- **geom_boxplot**
- **geom_violin**
- **geom_dotplot**
- **geom_density_ridges**
- **geom_point**
- **geom_errorbar**
- **geom_smooth**
- **geom_line**
- **geom_area**
- **geom_abline** (plus **geom_hline** and **geom_vline**)
- **geom_text**

Aesthetics

Here are some commonly used aesthetic types that can be manipulated in ggplot:

- **color**
- **fill**
- **shape**
- **size**
- **transparency**

Plotting continuous variables over time: Scatterplot and Line Plot

```
#^ defining some things for the graphs that will be applied to all graphs below  
#Scatterplot  
ggplot(EPAair, aes(x = Date, y = Ozone)) +  
  geom_point()
```

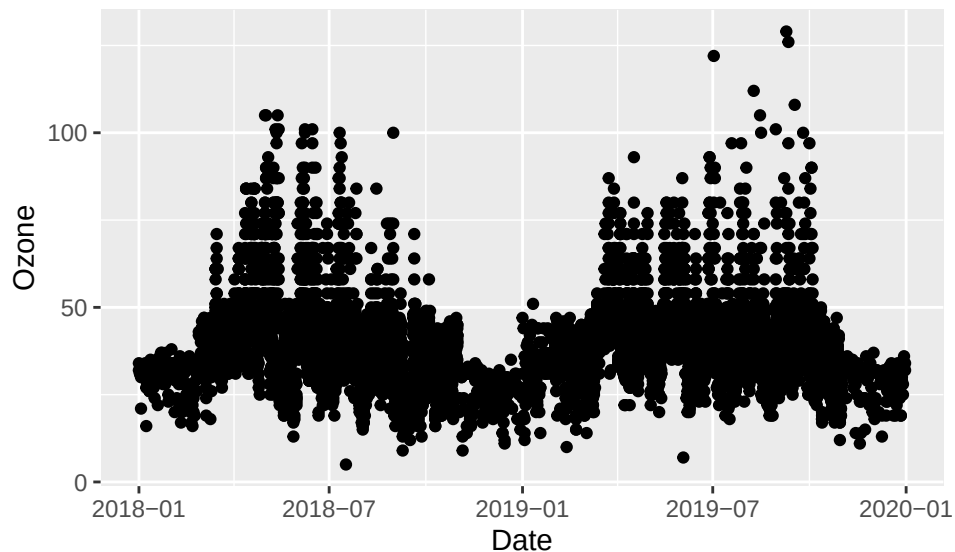


Figure 1: scatterplot

```
#generating same plot as above, just in a different way  
O3plot <- ggplot(EPAair) +  
  geom_point(aes(x = Date, y = Ozone)) #aesthetics can be in ggplot function or geom function  
print(O3plot) #shows you the plot
```

```
# Fix this code - adding color  
O3plot2 <- ggplot(EPAair) +  
  geom_point(aes(x = Date, y = Ozone), color = "blue")  
  #geom_point(aes(x = Date, y = Ozone, color = "blue")) #this is like adding another layer  
print(O3plot2)
```

```
# Add additional variables  
# How could you automatically assign a marker color to a variable?  
#different shapes depending on what the year is  
#all the observations from the same site will have the same color  
PMplot <-  
  ggplot(EPAair, aes(x = Month, y = PM2.5, shape = as.factor(Year), color = Site.Name)) +  
  geom_point()  
print(PMplot)
```

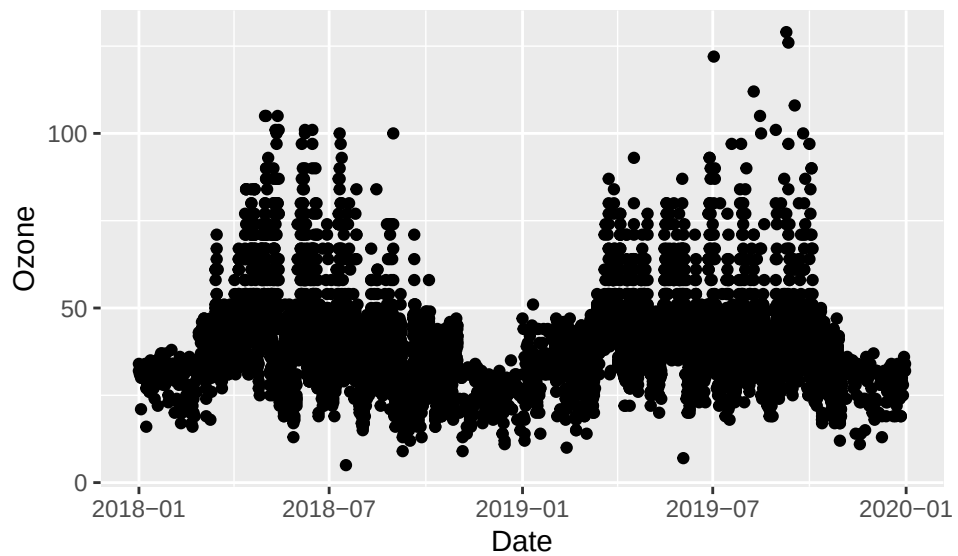


Figure 2: scatterplot

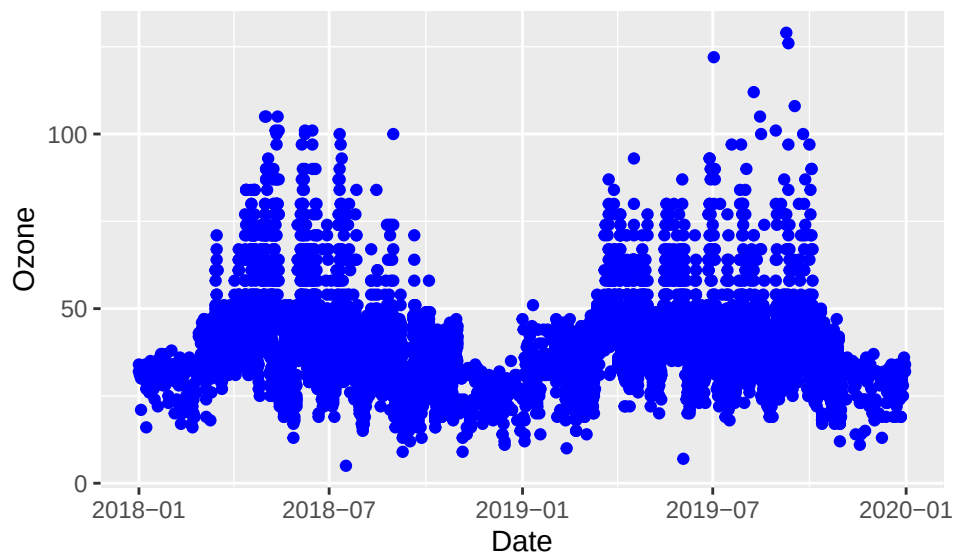


Figure 3: scatterplot



Figure 4: scatterplot

```
# Separate plot with facets
PMplot.faceted <-
  ggplot(EPAair, aes(x = Month, y = PM2.5, shape = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_point() +
  facet_wrap(vars(Site.Name), nrow = 3)
print(PMplot.faceted)
```

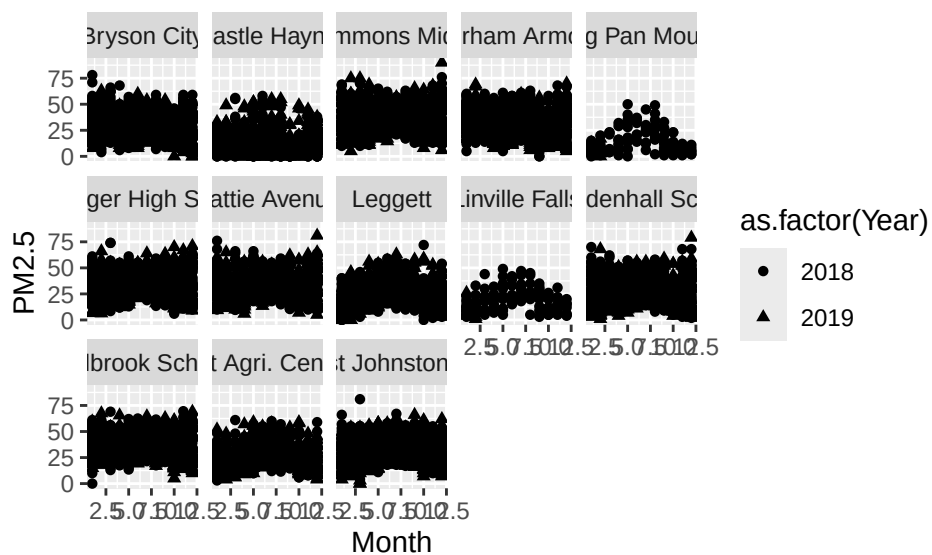


Figure 5: scatterplot

```
# Filter dataset within plot building and facet by multiple variables
PMplot.faceted2 <-
  ggplot(subset(EPAair, Site.Name == "Clemmons Middle" | Site.Name == "Leggett" |
```

```

    Site.Name == "Bryson City"),
  aes(x = Month, y = PM2.5)) +
  geom_point() +
  facet_grid(Site.Name ~ Year)
print(PMplot.faceted2)

```

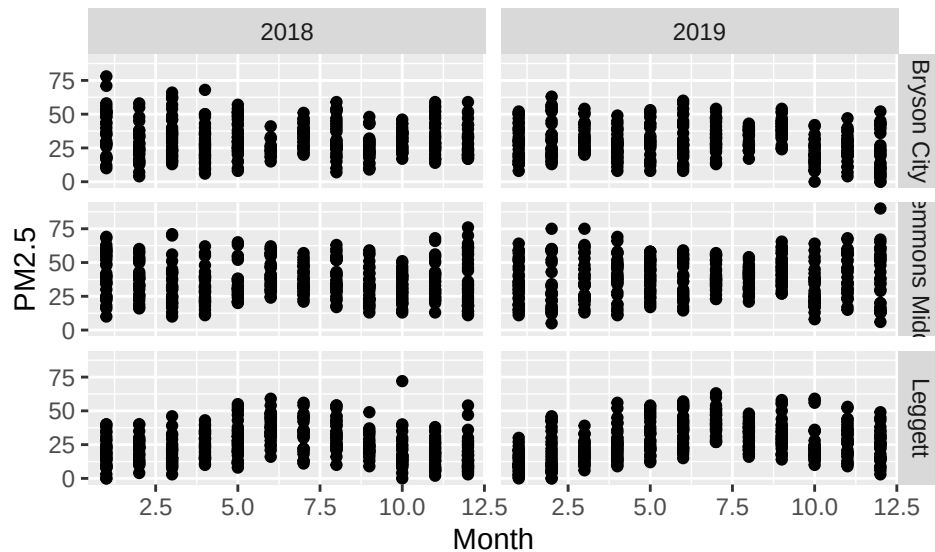


Figure 6: scatterplot

```

# Plot true time series with geom_line
PMplot.line <-
  ggplot(subset(EPAair, Site.Name == "Leggett"),
    aes(x = Date, y = PM2.5)) +
  geom_line()
print(PMplot.line)

```

Plotting the relationship between two continuous variables: Scatterplot

```

# Scatterplot
lightvsDO <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients, aes(x = irradianceWater, y = dissolvedOxygen)) +
  geom_point()
print(lightvsDO)

```

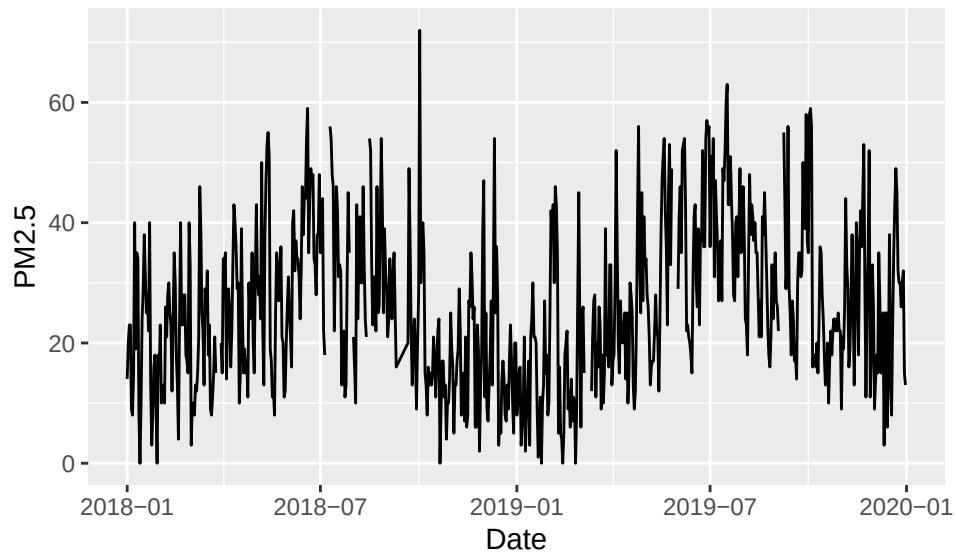
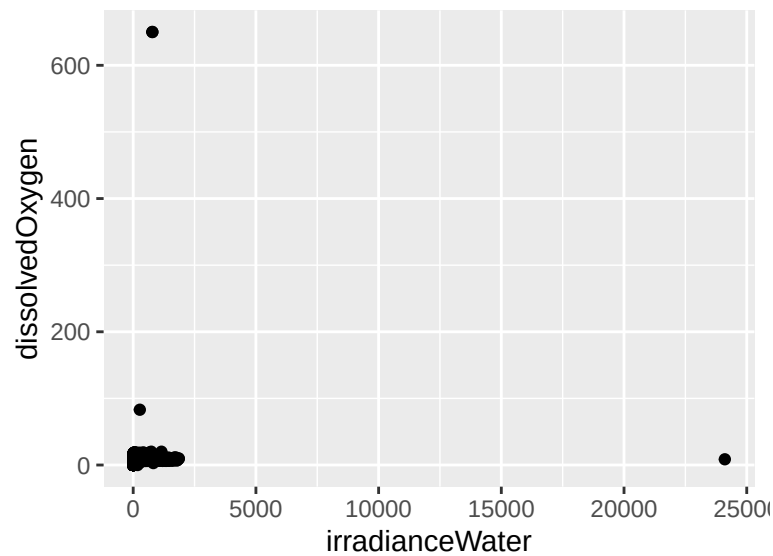
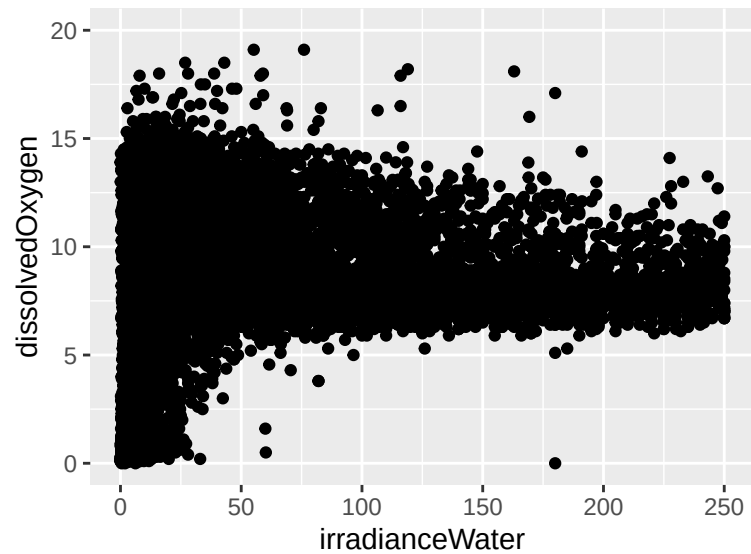


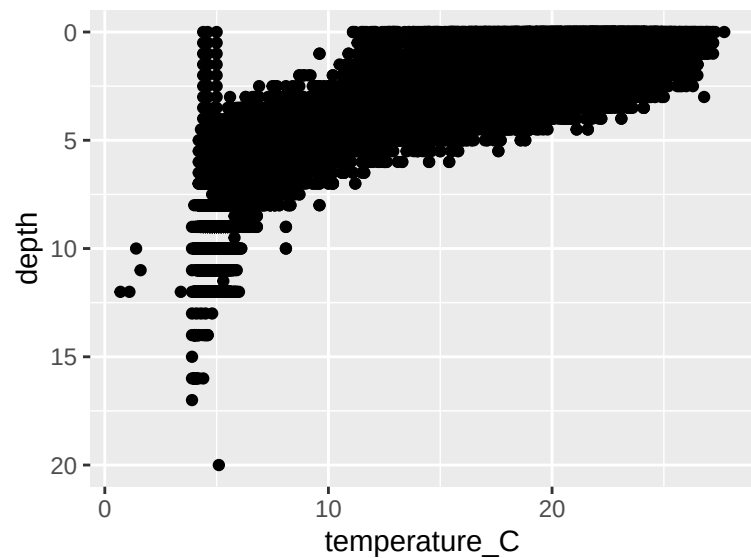
Figure 7: scatterplot



```
# Adjust axes- exclude outliers to generate better visualization
lightvsDOfixed <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients, aes(x = irradianceWater, y = dissolvedOxygen)) +
  geom_point() +
  xlim(0, 250) +
  ylim(0, 20)
print(lightvsDOfixed)
```

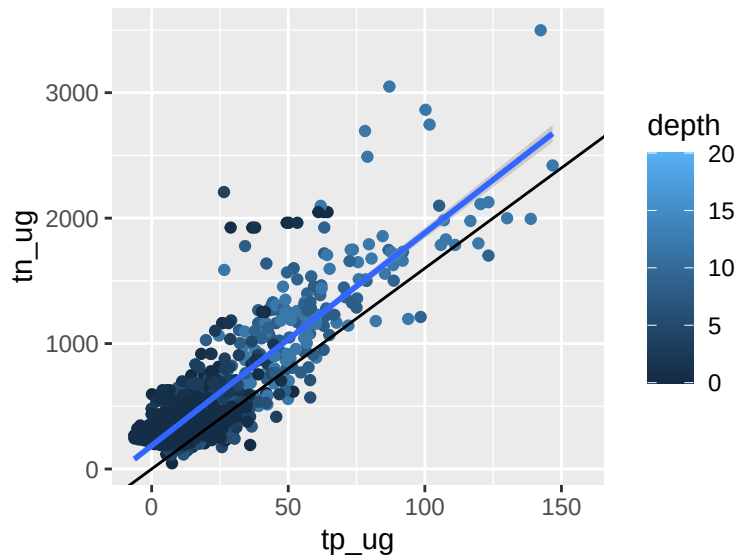


```
# Depth in the fields of limnology and oceanography is on a reverse scale
tempvsdepth <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients, aes(x = temperature_C, y = depth)) +
  #ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients, aes(x = temperature_C, y = depth, color = daynum)) +
  geom_point() +
  scale_y_reverse()
print(tempvsdepth)
```



```
NvsP <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients, aes(x = tp_ug, y = tn_ug, color = depth)) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_smooth(method = lm) + #adds trendline (linear)
  geom_abline(aes(slope = 16, intercept = 0))
print(NvsP)
```

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```

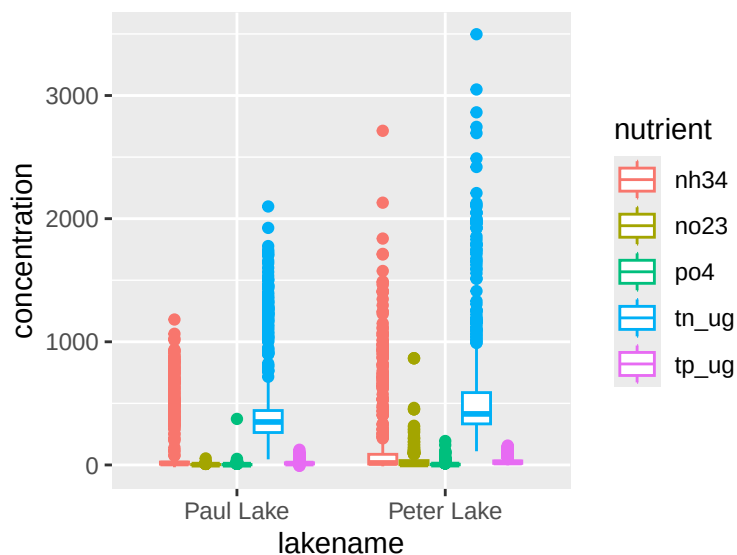



Plotting continuous vs. categorical variables

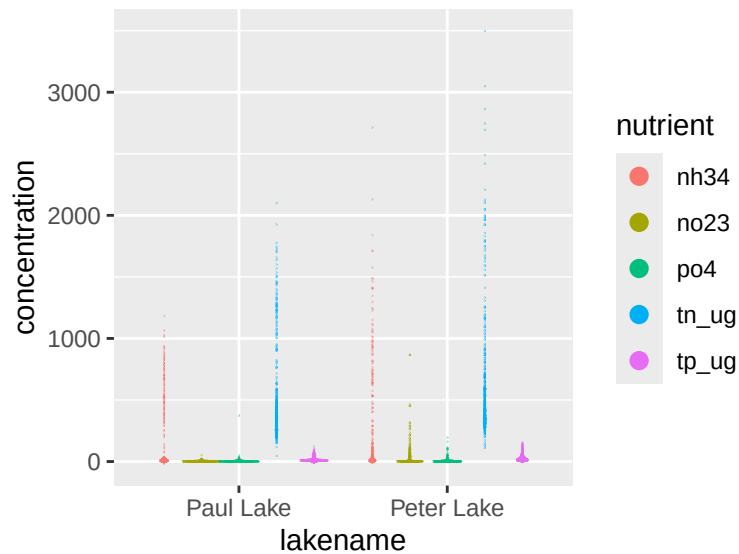
A traditional way to display summary statistics of continuous variables is a bar plot with error bars. Let's explore why this might not be the most effective way to display this type of data. Navigate to the Caveats page on Data to Viz (<https://www.data-to-viz.com/caveats.html>) and find the page that explores barplots and error bars.

What might be more effective ways to display the information? Navigate to the boxplots page in the Caveats section to explore further.

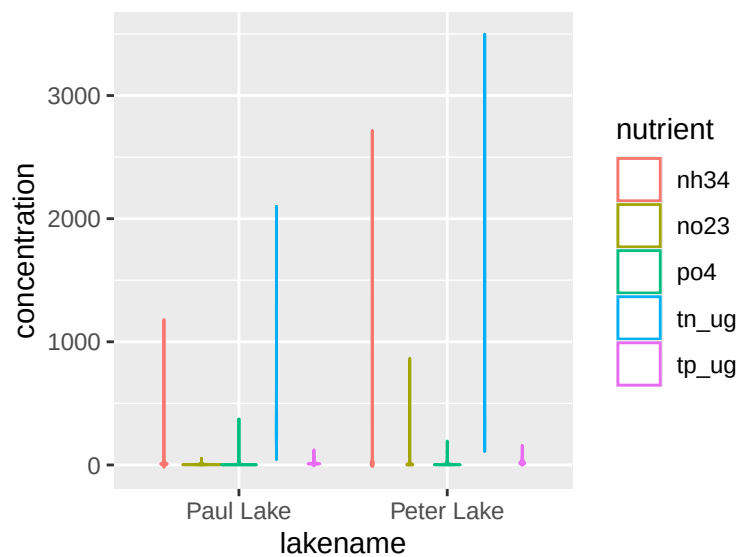
```
# Box and whiskers plot
Nutrientplot3 <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered, aes(x = lakename, y = concentration)) +
  geom_boxplot(aes(color = nutrient)) #separating nutrients by color-
#Why didn't we use "fill"? fill would just change the color within the boxplot
print(Nutrientplot3)
```



```
# Dot plot
Nutrientplot4 <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered, aes(x = lakename, y = concentration)) +
  geom_dotplot(aes(color = nutrient, fill = nutrient), binaxis = "y", binwidth = 1,
    stackdir = "center", position = "dodge", dotsize = 2) #
print(Nutrientplot4)
```



```
# Violin plot
Nutrientplot5 <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered, aes(x = lakename, y = concentration)) +
  geom_violin(aes(color = nutrient)) #
print(Nutrientplot5)
```



```

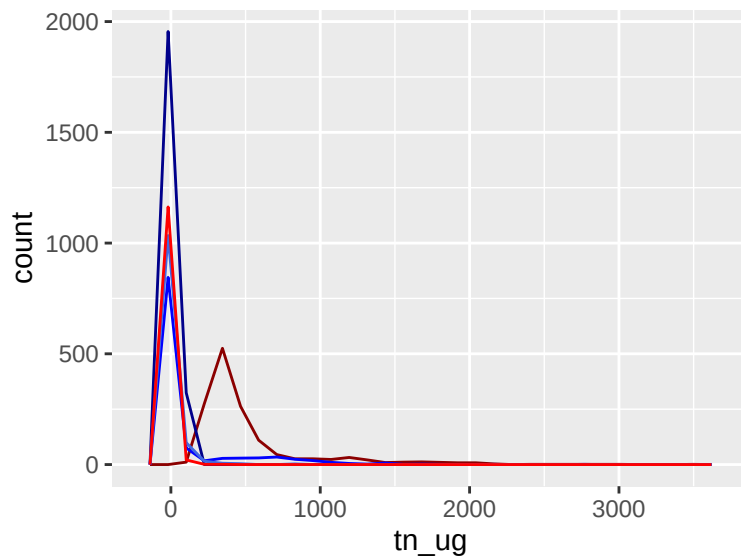
# Frequency polygons
# Using a tidy dataset
Nutrientplot6 <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients) +
    geom_freqpoly(aes(x = tn_ug), color = "darkred") +
    geom_freqpoly(aes(x = tp_ug), color = "darkblue") +
    geom_freqpoly(aes(x = nh34), color = "blue") +
    geom_freqpoly(aes(x = no23), color = "royalblue") +
    geom_freqpoly(aes(x = po4), color = "red")
print(Nutrientplot6)

```

```

## 'stat_bin()' using 'bins = 30'. Pick better value 'binwidth'.
## 'stat_bin()' using 'bins = 30'. Pick better value 'binwidth'.
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## 'stat_bin()' using 'bins = 30'. Pick better value 'binwidth'.

```



```

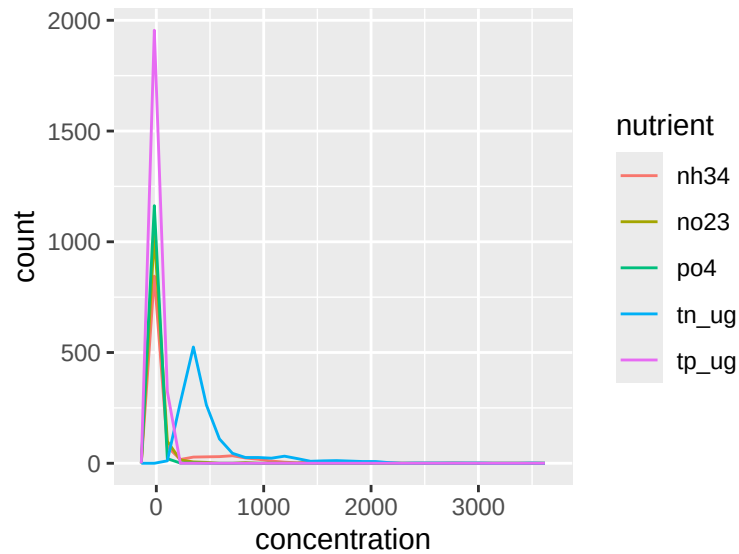
# Using a gathered dataset
Nutrientplot7 <-
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered) +
    geom_freqpoly(aes(x = concentration, color = nutrient))
print(Nutrientplot7)

```

```

## 'stat_bin()' using 'bins = 30'. Pick better value 'binwidth'.

```



*# Frequency polygons have the risk of becoming spaghetti plots.
See <<https://www.data-to-viz.com/caveat/spaghetti.html>> for more info.*

Ridgeline plot

```
Nutrientplot6 <-  
  ggplot(PeterPaul.chem.nutrients.gathered, aes(y = nutrient, x = concentration)) +  
  geom_density_ridges(aes(fill = lakename), alpha = 0.5) #  
print(Nutrientplot6)
```

Picking joint bandwidth of 10.9

